Sunday, November 8, 2026 | Vol. I · No. 33 · DRAM · NAND · HBM · Tel Aviv edition | Data as of ~08:20 IST · Weekend: no cash session · Last official: Friday closes · Spot: TrendForce Nov 6 18:10 GMT+8 (unchanged)

The Memory Cycle Journal

WEEKEND — LAST OFFICIAL (FRI)
KOSPI 5,059.69 −6.02%; Samsung ₩188,700 · SK hynix ₩1,132,000; foreigners −₩2.77T · no Sat/Sun session · Yonhap / Korea Herald

MICRON (FRI CLOSE) · SPOT UNCHANGED
$690.00 +5.12%; SOX 9,390.25 (+4.21%); DDR5 16Gb $60.167 (−0.82%) still Nov 6 18:10 GMT+8 · Exa, TrendForce

LEAD STORY

FOUNDRY · WEEKEND FOLLOW-UP

TSMC Restates Foundry Focus After Friday's 3D DRAM Report

A TSMC spokesperson told Tom's Hardware the company "focuses on our core business at all times, which is dedicated IC foundry," and that its mission is to remain "the trusted technology and capacity provider of the global logic IC industry." Tom's frames the remarks as a denial of Friday's report that TSMC was charting 3D DRAM at Nvidia's request. The quoted statement does not name 3D DRAM or Nvidia; the two accounts now conflict. Cash markets were closed. Spot DRAM is unchanged.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:20 IST Sunday (UTC+2) · Weekend: no US/Asia cash session · Last official Friday closes · Spot TrendForce Nov 6 18:10 GMT+8, unchanged · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · WEEKEND CARRY · FRIDAY OFFICIAL · SPOT UNCHANGED

ASIA, FRIDAY FINAL (NO WEEKEND SESSION)

KOSPI, Fri FINAL	**5,059.69 (−6.02%)**
Samsung, Fri FINAL	**₩188,700 (−6.35%)**
SK hynix, Fri FINAL	**₩1,132,000 (−10.44%)**
USD/KRW (Fri 15:30 KST)	**1,356.6**
Nikkei 225	**57,434.77 (−5.96%)**
Foreigners (Korea Fri)	**−₩2.77T**

US FRIDAY CLOSES AND SPOT (UNCHANGED)

Micron	**$690.00 (+5.12%)**
Sandisk	**$835.06 (+3.55%)**
SOX	**9,390.25 (+4.21%)**
Lam Research	**$200.44 (+8.23%)**
DDR5 16Gb spot	**$60.17 (−0.82%)**
DDR4 16Gb spot	**$80.82 (−1.06%)**
512Gb TLC wafer spot	**$16.15 (−4.33% w/w)**

What this shows: weekend carry. No Sat/Sun cash session in the US, Korea, Japan or Taiwan, and no new TrendForce DRAM print (live page still Last Update 2026-11-06 18:10 GMT+8). Friday's split tape stands: US rebound (MU $690 / +5.12%, SOX +4.21%) vs Asia plunge (KOSPI −6.02%, SK hynix −10.44%). Wafer weekly remains the Nov 4 Insights print; the live flash page is still stale Oct 26. Sources: Yonhap, Korea Herald, Exa, Motley Fool, TrendForce.

On Saturday, Tom's Hardware (Anton Shilov) published comments from a TSMC spokesperson: the company "focuses on our core business at all times, which is dedicated IC foundry," and "Our mission is to be the trusted technology and capacity provider of the global logic IC industry for years to come." Tom's presents this as "essentially… a denial" of Friday's The Information report, via Reuters, that TSMC had begun early plans for **3D DRAM** at Nvidia's request, led by Hsu Kuo-chin, including options to build a new fab or acquire/convert an existing plant (The Information / Reuters via Investing.com; Tom's Hardware, Nov 7).

FourWeekMBA notes that the quoted statement does **not mention 3D DRAM or Nvidia by name**. The Information's account (two people familiar; no timeline, capex or production date) still stands as reported — the two versions now conflict. Nvidia had still not commented in the Tom's and Reuters wraps. Tom's adds that even incumbents are years from commercial 3D DRAM, and that entering would take billions and years of DRAM-process R&D and could complicate TSMC's SK hynix HBM base-die partnership. Weekend chatter that "3D DRAM" might mean oxide-semiconductor eDRAM rather than commodity DRAM remains UNCONFIRMED — no new primary source. Either reading is still not near-term supply.

Physical prints did not move. TrendForce's DRAM spot page is still dated Nov 6, 18:10 GMT+8: DDR5 16Gb **$60.167 (−0.82%)**, DDR4 16Gb **$80.815 (−1.06%)**. The 512Gb TLC wafer weekly remains **$16.152 (−4.33% w/w)** from the Nov 4 Insights note. There was no third down day because there was no new session.

Our call: late upcycle; tight through 2027 / into 2028 — unchanged on supply. No new official prices, no new spot session, no verified China GAC October print. TSMC's 3D DRAM story is now contested by a foundry-focus statement; it was never near-term supply. Policy and sentiment risk remain elevated into a heavy week (Sandisk record and Onto Monday; TSMC sales and CPI Tuesday).

CYCLE SIGNAL: WEEKEND QUIET; PHYSICAL TIGHTNESS INTACT

SPECIALTY MEMORY · CYCLE COLOR

Winbond Chairman Hopes Memory Prices Have Peaked

Speaking to reporters at a weekend family-day event, Winbond chairman Arthur Chiao (焦佑鈞) said he does not think makers' 70–80% gross margins can keep climbing — "consumers have no money" — and that he hopes prices have peaked. Phone and PC unit sales are already down; further memory inflation, he argued, would push buyers to keep old devices another year. Only AI still absorbs higher prices. If the up-leg started in July 2025, a normal two-year rise would end around **June 2027**. He worries a downturn that arrives too late would encourage indiscriminate fab building. From CSP conversations, he said 2027–28 data-center funding, land, power and buildings are already in place, so those builds should not be blocked by a funding gap or a change in development permits; he dates the next downcycle risk to **2029**, when funding limits become the constraint. US midterms, he said, could hit AI DC builds by 3–5% (not worrying) or 30–50% (then worry) — outsiders cannot yet tell which. This is one specialty-memory chairman's view, not a broker supply-demand table (TechNews, Nov 7).

SELL-SIDE · RECIRCULATION

Citi Still Sees 2027 DRAM Undersupply at −3.8%

A Nov 3 Citi note, recirculated on X over the weekend rather than newly initiated, still has 2027 DRAM undersupplied after Citi raised supply on higher bit-growth guidance from Samsung and SK hynix. The 2027 DRAM supply-demand gap is **−3.8%** (was −8.7%): supply +24% / demand +28%. NAND's gap is −3.3% (was −6.1%): supply +22% / demand +26%. Citi raised 2027 capex-growth estimates to +55% DRAM / +35% NAND and put the current fulfillment ratio at about 70%. The note does not loosen a 2027 tightness call (Investing.com, Nov 3; chart relayed by @pequityresearch, Nov 8).

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE NOV 7, 08:20 IST

NEW **Apple's memory squeeze.** Q4 GM fell to 48% from 50% (about 1 point ex-tariffs, "primarily" memory). December-quarter GM guided to 45–46%. New CEO John Ternus called memory pricing "unprecedented." Manufacturing purchase commitments rose **$33 billion** in one quarter; memory shortages could continue restricting Mac and iPad output. App Economy Insights (Nov 7)

NEW **Muse: mid-cycle, not peak; MU and SNDK top picks.** SOX −12% on the week vs S&P +1%. Cantor: any GW/approval delay will be modest and "actually elongate the current cycle"; June–November sell-off is a mid-cycle correction. Semis ~13× CY28 consensus. Memory top picks: Micron and Sandisk. Buyers into Onto (Monday) and Applied Materials (Thursday). Cantor Weekly Muse-ings (Nov 7)

NEW **DC ballots: restrictions, few outright bans.** Of 47 data-center ballot measures tracked in 2026, 44 favored tighter restrictions as of Nov 5; only six (~13%) proposed outright bans. Cantor: a shift in bargaining power toward communities — delays and higher costs possible, not a wholesale rejection. Cantor Bits & Bolts (Nov 7)

NEW **Taylor Fab 1 said to have started operations.** A CCB International recap (Nov 2) in Sunday's AlphaSense hardware weekly says Samsung's Taylor Fab 1 "has officially started operations." Separate from the earlier Maeil/TrendForce report that Taylor Fab 2 is booked for 2nm HBM base dies (output ~2030). Also incremental in Jefferies' Saturday SEMIS Daily: Texas governor-elect Hinojosa on CNN said he does not "hate data centers" but "the way they are taking advantage of Texas"; August global semiconductor sales +144.3%, 2026 sales already above $1 trillion, with Jefferies modeling growth rates to peak around October. AlphaSense weekly / CCB (Nov 8 email); Jefferies SEMIS Daily Saturday

ON X · SINCE SAT ~08:20 · IST

@jukan05 · Nov 7 12:13
Questions how durable memory LTAs will be in a downcycle, citing onsemi and Microchip amendments and pushouts. The most reliable piece, he argues, is prepayments; volumes can slip a year or two without "breaking" the contract.
x.com/.../2119010267853881618

@damnang2 · Nov 7 19:15
Reply: cancel-or-defer treats memory as a plain commodity. The same customers jointly design next-generation HBM and 3D stacked DRAM; slipping deliveries would hit their own launch schedules.
x.com/.../2119116632606023798

@jukan05 · Nov 8 01:41
Rebuttal: joint design has not reached foundry-style customization, and does not settle who holds leftover inventory if an accelerator plan is cut. "Memory has completely shed its commodity character" is, in his view, the most dangerous claim.
x.com/.../2119213699835756708

@pequityresearch · Nov 8 02:21
Relays Citi's DRAM S/D chart: 2027E gap −3.8%. Underlying note is dated Nov 3 — weekend recirculation, not a new initiation (see lead section).
x.com/.../2119223835648274567

@pequityresearch · Nov 8 04:33
Relays Nomura: with big-tech responses and LTAs, the hit to memory from 2028F onward is "likely to be milder than the market fears." Original note not fetched. UNCONFIRMED vs the PDF.
x.com/.../2119256844602667491

@LiDaosen · Nov 8 01:50
Enters the LTA debate: HBM3E still allows multi-sourcing, "but HBM4 with TSMC logic base dies eliminates fungibility." Excess wafers, he argues, become underutilization write-offs, not spot dumping.
x.com/.../2119216066182422706

CYCLE TRACKER · SUPPLY TIGHT; WEEKEND QUIET; POLICY RISK STILL ELEVATED

GAUGE	TODAY VS NOV 7 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	No new contract print. Citi (Nov 3, recirculated) still has 2027 DRAM S/D −3.8% (supply +24% / demand +28%) after raising supply; NAND −3.3%	**Rising, slower**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $60.17 (−0.82%) and DDR4 16Gb $80.82 (−1.06%) unchanged — no new TrendForce session; wafer still $16.15 (−4.33% w/w)	**Unchanged**
LTAs / lead times	CCB/CFRA recaps: Micron 26 SCAs >35% of revenue through 2030; SKH 14 customers >50% of 2027–28 capacity. Weekend X debate: Jukan on LTA durability vs Damnang/LiDaosen on custom-HBM lock-in	**Long, firm**

Margins / guide	No new session (Fri split tape stands). Winbond's Chiao hopes prices have peaked; Apple guided Dec-quarter GM to 45–46% on memory costs. Equities still pricing midterm/DC-regulation risk	**Peak zone**
Capex / new supply	TSMC 3D DRAM now contested (spokesperson restates logic-foundry focus). YMTC 4th fab and Micron Fab 11E unchanged. CCB: Taylor Fab 1 has started operations	**Building, LT option**

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 32, NOV 7)

Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and into 2028 — unchanged on supply fundamentals. No new official prices, no new spot session, and China GAC October is still unverified. TSMC's 3D DRAM-at-Nvidia-request story is now contested by a company statement that restates dedicated logic-foundry focus (the quote does not name 3D DRAM or Nvidia); either way it is not near-term supply. Winbond's chairman hopes prices have peaked and sketches a normal two-year upcycle ending around June 2027 if dated from July 2025, but also says 2027–28 CSP builds are already funded and dates downcycle risk to 2029 — one specialty-maker view; Citi still has 2027 DRAM undersupply at −3.8%. Policy and sentiment risk remain elevated. Next: Sandisk record, Onto and Taiwan MOF Monday; TSMC October sales, US CPI, Infineon (European morning) and CoreWeave Tuesday; Korea 1–10 exports Wednesday (US equities stay open on Veterans Day); Applied Materials Thursday; Nvidia November 17.

EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 9–20 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

Mon Nov 9	Sandisk split record date (8-for-1) · Onto Innovation after the close (call 23:30 IST) · Taiwan MOF Oct trade 10:00 IST	NAND
Tue Nov 10	TSMC October sales 07:30 IST · US CPI 15:30 · Infineon Q4/FY (European morning) · CoreWeave after the close	AI
Wed Nov 11	Korea Nov 1–10 exports · US Veterans Day — equity markets open (bonds typically closed)	Trade
Thu Nov 12	Nebius before the open · Applied Materials after the close · Fri: US PPI 15:30	WFE
Tue Nov 17	Nvidia FQ3 results (call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 exhibits Nov 17–19	HBM
Thu Nov 20	Sandisk first split-adjusted trading day (effective after close Nov 19)	NAND
Watch	China GAC October trade still not independently verified	Trade

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